

ESTABLISHING A SCHOOL CHANGEMAKER CLUB

masifundesi
**CHANGE
MAKER**
NETWORK



Participating Provinces with Changemaker Clubs

The Masifunde's
Changemaker Network
(MCN) empowers
South African Grade 9

learners with skills in leadership, gender-based violence prevention, school safety, and environmental awareness. Operating across all nine provinces through 40 civil society partners and over 200 schools, the programme enables youth to lead positive change in their communities. With support from the TUI Care Foundation, it expanded into "Eco Champions," hosting its first National Eco Champion Summit in Gqeberha in 2025 to foster collaboration on environmental solutions. Today, the network continues to support learners in leading school campaigns, establishing Changemaker Clubs, and carrying out Community Action Projects for lasting, sustainable impact.



About TUI Junior Academy:

The TUI Junior Academy programme inspires young people to protect nature and wildlife and empowers them to become Eco Champions in their communities. It builds awareness for the fragility of nature by developing these competencies in schools and communities and brings the classroom to life through excursions and nature-based experiences.



basic education
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Basic Education
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More on Masifunde www.masifunde.org
More on the Changemaker Network
www.Changemaker-Network.org



A Changemaker Club is a learner-led school club that promotes social awareness, leadership and active citizenship in areas of public concern in schools.

It's a club run by learners, for the school.

The club is part of the Changemaker Network, which means learners get support from trained changemakers, teachers, and partner organisations.

*Example name: St. Thomas Changemaker Club
(It is named after YOUR school.)*

WHAT does the club do?

- Raise awareness about issues affecting your school (like litter, bullying, or recycling)
- Helps learners become better leaders
- Run real projects that improve the school community

WHO can join?

- The club consist of a total members: 15–20 learners max
- Grades: 8 to 11
- Its leadership is formed by trained changemakers
- Other clubs (like RCL or Eco Club) can send one person each to join – teamwork over competition!

THE CHANGEMAKER CLUB MEMBERS meet at least once a month, to plan and organization initiatives, campaigns as well as Community Action Projects. The Changemaker club can also host fundraising initiatives as the club does not have any funds. The money fundraised should always be used for the benefit of the school.

Here's a step-by-step guide to establish your school's Changemaker Club



Build Your Team

- 5 trained changemakers (your core committee)
 - 2+ Changemaker Teachers
 - Support from school management and a Partner Organization
- Check on www.changemaker-network.org under the 'Partner Area' section

01

Name Your Club

Use your school's name.
Example: Greenwood High Changemaker Club

02

Recruit 15–20 Members

- Start with the 5 trained changemakers
- Add workshop participants and nominees
 - Include active, committed learners
- Invite representatives from other clubs
 - Keep membership to Grades 8–11

03

Form Your Committee

The 5 trained changemakers become the leadership team.
Rotate roles annually and give other members opportunities to lead.

04

05

Establish Reporting Lines

- Members → Committee
 - Committee → Teachers & Partner Organization
 - Teachers → School Management
 - Partner Organization → masifunde
- All projects require approval from teachers and school management.*





10

Fundraise Responsibly

- Get teacher approval first
- Use funds for club activities or school support
- Manage funds with the committee, school management, and Partner Organization

09

Track Your Progress by recording

- Attendance
- Decisions made
- Action dates
- Results achieved

This shows the club is active and accountable.

08

Keep Members Engaged

- Follow up after two missed meetings
- Give everyone a meaningful role

07

Launch a Small Project - something simple and visible

- Litter clean-up
- Mental health awareness campaign
- Kindness Week
- Recycling competition

Remember: Get approval before you start.

06

Plan Your First Meeting - with an agenda something like this:

1. Welcome & attendance
2. Identify an issue or topic
3. Brainstorm solutions
4. Assign roles
5. Confirm next meeting
6. Fun wrap-up

Meet at least once a month.



COMMUNITY ACTION PROJECTS



Community Action Projects (CAPs) are learner-led initiatives that aim to improve the school or local community through positive and practical action. These projects encourage learners to identify real issues around them and work together with their school community to create meaningful change.

CAPs build teamwork, leadership, responsibility, and a strong sense of community pride.



CAP ideas

Large-Scale Projects

- **School Maintenance**
Assist with fixing or improving school facilities where possible
- **Classroom Makeovers**
Refresh classrooms with paint, decorations, or better layouts
- **Reducing Vandalism**
Paint murals or upgrade shared spaces like toilets to promote respect
- **Waste Management**
Organize systems for regularly emptying and maintaining dustbins

Smaller-Scale Projects

- **Clean-Up Campaigns**
Organize basic school or community clean-ups
- **Garden Clubs**
Support or expand existing school gardens
- **Green Your Space Challenge**
Add plants (like Spekboom) and eco-posters to classrooms
- **Awareness Campaigns**
Share key messages (e.g. #FeedTheBins-StarveTheGround, #Be Kind To The Environment -Don't Litter) to inspire action
- **Waste Management**
Take responsibility for keeping specific areas clean

Working Together

To make CAPs more impactful, partner with people and organizations that can help:

- Reach out to local businesses for materials or support
- Collaborate with organizations that focus on safer schools or environmental awareness
- Involve teachers, parents, and community members in planning and execution

Why CAPs Matter

- Improves the school and community environment
- Develops leadership and teamwork skills
- Encourages responsibility and active citizenship
- Creates positive change

Every small action counts. Be a changemaker – see a problem, take action, and make a difference!

Start small. Stay active.

Have fun!

You don't need permission to care about your school – just a plan and a few friends.

That's a Changemaker Club.

masifunde's **CHANGE MAKER** NETWORK

The Changemaker Network aims to capacitate learners with knowledge on various social topics through activation workshops and changemaker trainings so that they can spark positive change through campaigns in their respective schools and communities.



This project gets replicated nationwide in all 9 provinces of South Africa in partnership with 40 Civil Society Organizations, 200 SCHOOLS and ultimately training 1000 CHANGEMAKERS.

An initiative by:



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LEARNER DEVELOPMENT



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